

Maria Silva

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Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the Junior Legal Secretary role at Birchrose Associates because my background in property disputes and legal document management at BCLP gives me a practical foundation for supporting a busy property team from day one.

During my year at BCLP, I spent six months in the Real Estate Disputes team supporting fee earners across multiple concurrent matters. I prepared electronic hearing bundles, assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials, maintained matter records on iManage, handled court filings and tracked deadlines across competing instructions. Managing large volumes of confidential documents under time pressure while keeping files accurate and organised was a core part of the role, and it is the kind of work I find genuinely satisfying to do well. I received feedback from a partner and associate that my performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor, which I think reflected how seriously I took the administrative and document management side of the work, not just the legal research.

Alongside that, my current role at Citizens Advice requires me to manage matters from initial instruction through to submission, drafting correspondence, preparing document schedules and maintaining confidential case records to deadline. Translating complex procedural requirements into clear, practical steps for clients is something I do regularly, including for individuals dealing with housing and debt matters, which has sharpened how I communicate and organise information under pressure.

I am drawn to this role in a property team specifically because property disputes at BCLP was where I saw most clearly how important precise document management and reliable administrative support are to how a matter runs. Fee earners dealing with rights of light, leasehold disputes and landlord and tenant matters depend on that support being accurate and timely. I would bring that understanding, along with direct experience of the tools and workflows, to this position.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva